James #1

You Can Have Joy No Matter What

January 9, 2022

Text: James 1:1-4

I. The epistle of James was written as a plea for vital Christianity in the face of trouble. (v. 1)

A. James, half brother of Jesus (Matt. 13:55-56; John 7:2-5), has come to a place in his faith where he is a bond-servant. (Doulos- slave)

B. "... twelve tribes ..." - All Jewish Christians. (Matt. 19:28; Acts 26:7)

C. "dispersed" - (diaspora - Assyrians - II Kings 17; Babylonians - II Kings 24-25; Roman occupation and slavery; Harsh rule of Herod Agrippa I - Acts 12)

II. "Consider it all joy ..." (v. 2-4) (Grace and peace - I Peter 1:1-2)

A. Joy is always available and must be chosen. (Phil. 3:1; II Cor. 8:1-2)

B. "... various trials ..." - Test of faithfulness; discomfort that is designed to "...produce endurance." (II Cor. 12:7-10)

C. The result is "perfect" (I John 2:14) and "complete". (I Peter 5:10) Christian maturity.

* Don't forget the tools that God has left us for the purpose of encouraging faithfulness: God's Word - Heb. 4:12; The Holy Spirit - Gal. 5:22-23; The Church - Heb. 10:24-25